

Laurent Colbois

AI/ML EXPERT · PHD IN MACHINE LEARNING & BIOMETRICS

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"To create a positive impact through technology while following sustainable practices."

Recruitment Team

February 4, 2026

BERNER FACHHOCHSCHULE (BFH)
BERN, SWITZERLAND

Bewerbung als Fachverantwortliche*r Künstliche Intelligenz

Sehr geehrte Damen und Herren,

Why This Role Resonates With Me

After five years of research at Idiap, I have discovered that what energizes me most is not producing my own research outputs, but rather enabling others to succeed with theirs. Throughout my PhD and postdoc, I found greatest satisfaction when supporting master's students on their projects, when explaining AI concepts to forensic practitioners, and when coordinating cross-functional teams to solve shared problems. The position of AI Expert at BFH appeals to me precisely because supporting, advising, training, and connecting people across teaching, research, and operations is the core mission—not a side activity.

The description of working with "einem bunten Haufen aufgestellter Menschen mit ganz unterschiedlichen Biografien" captures what I seek: a role where variety and interdisciplinary collaboration are central, where I can help many different people tackle diverse AI challenges rather than focusing narrowly on a single technical problem.

What I Bring to the Role

AI/ML Expertise & Practical Experience: My PhD and postdoc at Idiap provided deep expertise in machine learning, deep learning, computer vision, and most recently Vision-Language Models. I have hands-on experience with modern ML frameworks (PyTorch, Huggingface Transformers, vLLM), MLOps tools (Weights & Biases, MLFlow, Hydra), and HPC/GPU infrastructure (Slurm clusters, containerization). I understand both the technical foundations and the practical challenges of applying AI in research contexts.

Teaching, Mentoring & Support: I supervised four master's students, taught an annual course on forensic evaluation methods, and regularly served as the "go-to person" in my lab for questions about reproducible workflows, experiment tracking, and code quality. I understand how to meet people where they are—whether explaining concepts to beginners or troubleshooting technical details with experienced researchers.

Communication Across Audiences: Throughout my work, I've successfully translated complex AI topics for diverse stakeholders: forensic scientists, police forces, legal personnel, and most recently investors and business mentors during a startup hackathon. I adapt my communication style to audience background, balancing technical accuracy with accessibility. This skill is essential for the central coordination and support role at BFH.

Project Coordination & Stakeholder Management: My experience coordinating a forensic data collection platform—managing communication between researchers, developers, and legal staff—taught me the importance of clear requirements, prioritization, and maintaining structured communication channels across different organizational units.

Language Note & Practical Details

I am fully fluent in French (mother tongue) and English. Regarding German: I achieved B2 level and spent 5 months during military service working entirely in German. However, I have not used German professionally in recent years, so I would need some time to reactivate fluency. I am committed to doing so and confident that immersion in a German-speaking work environment would

accelerate this process. I recognize that supporting BFH colleagues in German is part of the role, and I am prepared to invest in language development as needed.

I am Swiss, available to start in mid-May 2026, and open to the commute to Bern with the possibility of remote work. My salary expectation is in the range of 100-120K CHF (pro-rata for 80-100%), though I am open to discussion based on the role and institutional context.

Looking Forward

I would be excited to contribute to BFH's AI journey by helping teaching staff, researchers, and administrative teams navigate AI tools and methods effectively. This position aligns perfectly with my strengths, values, and vision for meaningful work that enables others to succeed.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to discussing how I can support BFH's community in adopting and leveraging AI responsibly and effectively.

Mit freundlichen Grüßen,

Laurent Colbois

Beiliegend: Lebenslauf